🌊 WATER SAFETY SCENARIO CARDS

Year 7–8 HPE · Classroom Station Activities · Victorian Curriculum 2.0 · Safety Focus Area

🏖 BEACH SCENARIOS

🏖 The Unpatrolled Beach — B1

Scene: It's a hot Saturday in January. Your group of friends (8 of you) arrive at a remote beach near Torquay. There are no flags, no lifeguards, and no signs. The surf looks rough. One friend says, "Don't be a wimp — let's just go in!" Two others start walking toward the water.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 What are THREE safety concerns with this situation?

Q2 What would you say to your friends? Write the exact words.

Q3 What should you do instead of swimming at this location?

Q4 Why is peer pressure especially dangerous near water?

🏖 Beach · 👥 Peer pressure

SwimSafe: Read Signs · Swim with a Friend

🌊 Caught in a Rip — B2

Scene: Maya, 13, is swimming between the flags at a patrolled beach in Phillip Island. She feels herself being pulled sideways and then out from shore. The more she tries to swim back, the more tired she gets. She's about 30m from shore and starting to panic.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 What is Maya most likely caught in? How can she tell?

Q2 What is the WORST thing Maya can do right now? Why?

Q3 Describe the three steps Maya should take to survive.

Q4 What should her friends on the beach do?

🌊 Rip current · 🏊 Survival swimming

Signal for Help · Stay Calm · Swim Parallel

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🚩 The Flag Problem B3

Scene: You arrive at Torquay beach with your family. You can see: two red-and-yellow flags about 100m to your left, a black-and-white quartered flag area 30m in front of you, and an orange windsock flying near the patrol tent. Your younger cousin (8 years old) wants to jump in right where you're standing and has brought a blow-up crocodile.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 What does each of the three flags mean?

Q2 Where should your family swim? Explain your reasoning.

Q3 Why is the inflatable crocodile a problem today? Be specific.

Q4 What would you say to your 8-year-old cousin?

🏖 Beach flags · 🟠 Windsock

SwimSafe: Read Signs · Swim Between Flags

🏞 RIVER & INLAND WATERWAY SCENARIOS

The Rope Swing R1

Scene: A popular river spot in the Yarra Valley has a rope swing over the water. It's a hot day and kids have been using it all afternoon. A Year 9 student you don't know swings out and lets go awkwardly. He hits the water and doesn't come back up. His friends are panicking. You are standing on the bank with a towel and your phone.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 What is your FIRST action? Why not jump in?

Q2 How do you use the towel to help without entering the water?

Q3 Walk through the DRS ABCD steps if the person is pulled out unconscious.

Q4 What are THREE hazards at this location you should have noticed BEFORE this happened?

🏞 River | 🩺 DRS ABCD | THROW, DON'T GO

After the Rain R2

Scene: It rained heavily last night but today is sunny and warm. Your group wants to swim in their favourite river spot near Warburton. The water looks higher and faster than usual, and it's a murky brown colour. One friend says it looks fine and starts getting changed.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 List FOUR specific hazards that high, murky, fast river water creates.

Q2 Why does the murky brown colour matter for safety?

Q3 Your friend says "I swam here last week and it was fine." How do you respond?

Q4 What is a safer alternative for cooling off today?

🌧 Inland waterway | ⚠️ Flood conditions | Conditions change rapidly

🌡 Cold Water Shock

R3

Scene: Jake (Year 8) and his family are camping near Lake Eildon in December. It's 36°C. Jake sees people on the news about cold water shock but thinks "it's summer so the water must be warm." He runs and jumps into the lake. Within seconds he gasps involuntarily, his muscles seize up, and he can't control his breathing. He's only in waist-deep water but starts to panic.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 What is cold water shock and why did it happen on a hot day?

Q2 What should Jake's parents have told him before he got in?

Q3 Why is the "gasping" reflex so dangerous even in shallow water?

Q4 What is the safe way to enter cold water?

🌡 Cold water 🏔 Alpine lakes

Enter feet first · Acclimatise slowly

🏊 POOL & BACKYARD SCENARIOS

🏊 Pool Party Emergency P1

Scene: You're at a friend's pool party (Year 8, about 20 kids). The adults have gone inside to get food. Everyone is laughing and music is loud. You look over and notice a 13-year-old face-down and motionless at the shallow end. No one else has noticed.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 Describe exactly what you do in the first 30 seconds.

Q2 Write the words you would shout to get adult help.

Q3 If the person is not breathing, what do you do? List the steps in order.

Q4 What could have been done BEFORE this happened to reduce the risk?

🏊 Pool · 🩺 DRS ABCD

Act immediately · Call 000

🏠 The Backyard Pool P2

Scene: You're babysitting your 4-year-old neighbour at their home. The backyard has a pool. The gate appears to be shut. You're inside making lunch and you hear silence — you realise you haven't heard the child in a few minutes.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 What do you do immediately?

Q2 Why is "silence" actually a warning sign around water with young children?

Q3 What should have been done when you first arrived as the babysitter?

Q4 What are THREE pool safety features every backyard pool should have?

🏠 Backyard pool · 👧 Young child safety

Drowning is silent · Active supervision

🩺 EMERGENCY RESPONSE SCENARIOS

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🆘 Calling 000 E1

Scene: You are at an unpatrolled beach. An adult has been pulled out of the water by two bystanders. He is lying on the sand, unconscious, and not breathing. One person is attempting CPR. Your job is to call 000. You're shaking.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 Write down exactly what you would say when 000 answers.

Q2 What information does the operator NEED from you?

Q3 Should you hang up once you've given the information? Why or why not?

Q4 What if you don't know the exact address?

📞 000 🚑 Emergency services

Never hang up · Give exact location

🪢 Throw Rescue E2

Scene: A young woman has slipped off the jetty at a lake near Gippsland and is struggling in the water 5 metres from the edge. She can't swim. You have: a coiled rope, a life ring attached to the jetty, your jumper, and a wooden plank on the jetty. She is panicking and going under.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 Rank the four items from BEST to WORST rescue tool. Explain your ranking.

Q2 Describe HOW you would use the best rescue tool. Be specific.

Q3 Why should you NOT jump in to save her, even if you're a strong swimmer?

Q4 What should you shout to her while you're attempting the rescue?

🪢 Throw rescue 🚫 Don't enter water

Throw, Don't Go

⚖️ DECISION-MAKING & RISK SCENARIOS

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⚖️ The Group Decision D1

Scene: It's New Year's Day. You're with 10 friends at the Mornington Peninsula. The patrolled beach is a 20-minute walk away. Half the group wants to swim at the nearby unpatrolled beach "to save time." The other half (including you) wants to go to the patrolled beach. The unpatrolled beach has no signs, no flags, and looks rougher.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 Using the LSV drowning data: what time of year and location are drownings most likely?

Q2 Write a persuasive argument to convince the group to walk to the patrolled beach.

Q3 What does "Victoria had zero public-pool drowning deaths in 2024–25, but a quarter of deaths were in home environments" tell your friends?

Q4 If you're outvoted and the group swims at the unpatrolled beach, what precautions should you all take?

⚖️ Decision-making | 📊 Uses LSV data

Always swim between the flags

🍺 Alcohol & Water D2

Scene: A group of 18-year-olds are celebrating finishing Year 12. They're at a house with a pool. Most have been drinking. One person (who has had several drinks) decides to jump in the pool for a swim at 1am to "cool off." His friends cheer him on.

📝 DISCUSS & ANSWER

Q1 List FOUR ways alcohol specifically increases drowning risk.

Q2 What should his friends do? What would most people actually do? Why is there a gap?

Q3 Why is night-time swimming especially risky?

Q4 If someone in this situation becomes unconscious in the pool, what complicates the DRS ABCD response?

🍺 Alcohol risk | 🌙 Night swimming

Never mix alcohol and water

🌟 EXTENSION & RESEARCH CARDS

⭐ EXTENSION CARD X1 — DATA ANALYSIS

Analysing Victorian Drowning Statistics

Visit: **https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy**

- Find the most recent LSV drowning report. What was the total number of drowning deaths?
- What percentage were aged 15–24? Calculate this from the raw data.
- What were the TOP 3 locations for drowning deaths? What does this tell you about risk?
- Create a bar graph comparing deaths by age group. Which group has the highest rate per population?
- Compare Victoria to national data at: **https://www.royallifesaving.com.au/research**

⭐ EXTENSION CARD X2 — COMMUNITY ACTION

Water Safety Communication Campaign

Design a water safety awareness campaign for ONE of the following target audiences:

- **Option A:** Teenagers aged 13–17 — create an Instagram carousel (3 slides) using real statistics and a compelling message
- **Option B:** Recent migrants and multicultural community — create a factsheet explaining beach flag meanings and Victorian waterway risks in simple English
- **Option C:** Primary school students (Year 5–6) — create a 5-panel comic strip teaching the SwimSafe rules

Your campaign must include at least ONE real statistic with its source URL.

⭐ EXTENSION CARD X3 — CROSS-CURRICULAR HEALTH

Physiology of Drowning — Research Task

Research and explain what happens in the body during a drowning emergency. Your response should address:

- What happens to oxygen levels in the blood within minutes of submersion?
- Why does brain damage occur so quickly? (hint: research cerebral hypoxia)
- How does CPR maintain circulation until the heart can restart?
- Why is early CPR + early defibrillation the most important factor in survival?

Sources: **https://www.stjohnvic.com.au** | **https://www.heartfoundation.org.au**

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · HPE · Year 7–8 · Safety Focus Area (VC2HP8P10) · Sources: Life Saving Victoria – https://lsv.com.au · LSV Drowning Reports – https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy · Victoria Police – https://www.police.vic.gov.au/beach-and-waterways-safety

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